

Business

1. Nintendo just reported its quarterly results, and the Switch 2 console launch plus a certain Hollywood blockbuster sent profits sharply higher. By roughly how much did net profit jump in the April-June quarter?
 - a. Around 25%, a solid but unspectacular beat
 - b. Around 54%, comfortably smashing expectations
 - c. Around 80%, the biggest quarter in Nintendo's history
2. Germany's car industry is in the middle of a painful restructuring. BMW recently joined Volkswagen, Porsche, and Mercedes-Benz in announcing significant job cuts. What is the main force driving this industry-wide cull?
 - a. A collapse in European consumer demand caused by rising interest rates
 - b. Chinese rivals eating into their market share at home and abroad
 - c. New EU emissions rules making current models illegal to sell
3. French energy giant TotalEnergies recently struck a deal that signals a significant shift in how big oil companies think about their futures. Shell had a portfolio of European onshore renewable energy businesses — wind farms, solar projects and the like. What did TotalEnergies just do?
 - a. Agreed to buy those renewable assets from Shell in a major cross-border acquisition
 - b. Launched a joint venture with Shell to co-manage the renewable portfolio
 - c. Blocked Shell's attempt to sell the assets to a Chinese state energy company
4. The energy drinks market just got a lot more dramatic. Russ Savage — founder of Rockstar Energy — has been quietly building a stake in Celsius Holdings, a rival energy drink brand. What has he reportedly done next?
 - a. Launched a new energy drink specifically designed to taste identical to Celsius
 - b. Filed a lawsuit claiming Celsius stole Rockstar's original formula
 - c. Accumulated a 4.7% stake and is now pushing to become Celsius's CEO

Economics

5. Ghana's inflation (the rate at which prices across the economy are rising) has been falling, and July brought more good news. Inflation dropped to 4.6% in July, down from 5.3% in June. Which sector drove the latest monthly decline?
 - a. Energy prices, as global oil costs fell sharply
 - b. Food prices, which make up a large share of the Ghanaian consumer basket
 - c. Housing costs, following a government rent control intervention

6. France has just announced a ban on unsolicited telemarketing calls — cold calls — starting next week, after years of complaints that existing rules weren't working. Which of the following is NOT a plausible economic risk of this kind of ban?
 - a. Job losses in call centres that rely on outbound sales as their core business model
 - b. A sudden spike in inflation as companies lose a cheap customer acquisition channel
 - c. Reduced revenues for businesses that depend heavily on phone-based direct sales
7. Ahead of a planned visit by President Xi Jinping to Washington, China announced sweeping new trade curbs against the United States, including export controls on drones. What were these measures widely understood to be?
 - a. Retaliation for US restrictions on Chinese technology companies
 - b. A precondition China set for agreeing to any new trade talks
 - c. A response to new US military exercises in the South China Sea
8. New OECD (the club of wealthy nations) data has revealed a striking disconnect between economic growth and ordinary living standards. In which two European countries did real household incomes — what families actually have to spend, adjusted for inflation — actually fall, even as the broader economy grew?
 - a. Greece and Austria
 - b. Italy and Portugal
 - c. Hungary and Romania

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cobalt, the metal essential for manufacturing the rechargeable batteries used in electric vehicles and smartphones?
 - a. The Democratic Republic of Congo
 - b. Australia
 - c. Chile
10. Which 18th-century economist, working as a customs officer in Scotland by day, wrote what many consider the founding text of modern capitalism in his spare time — a book published in 1776 that argued free markets and the division of labour drive national wealth?
 - a. Adam Smith, who wrote The Wealth of Nations
 - b. David Hume, who wrote A Treatise on Commerce
 - c. Thomas Malthus, who wrote An Inquiry into Prosperity

Business

1. Nintendo just reported its quarterly results, and the Switch 2 console launch plus a certain Hollywood blockbuster sent profits sharply higher. By roughly how much did net profit jump in the April-June quarter?

b. Nintendo's net profit rose 54% in the April-June quarter. The Switch 2 drove hardware demand while the Mario movie added a lucrative licensing stream — a reminder that Nintendo is as much an IP company as a gadget maker. The result comfortably beat analyst forecasts and came despite a broader slowdown in consumer electronics spending globally.

2. Germany's car industry is in the middle of a painful restructuring. BMW recently joined Volkswagen, Porsche, and Mercedes-Benz in announcing significant job cuts. What is the main force driving this industry-wide cull?

b. Chinese carmakers — led by brands like BYD — have undercut German manufacturers on price, particularly in electric vehicles, eroding their dominance in Europe and in China itself, once their most profitable market. Germany's auto sector employs around 800,000 people directly, so the restructuring has become a major political as well as economic story.

3. French energy giant TotalEnergies recently struck a deal that signals a significant shift in how big oil companies think about their futures. Shell had a portfolio of European onshore renewable energy businesses — wind farms, solar projects and the like. What did TotalEnergies just do?

a. TotalEnergies agreed to acquire Shell's European onshore wind and solar businesses outright. The deal is striking because it shows two oil majors moving in opposite directions — Shell trimming its renewables exposure while TotalEnergies expands it. It reflects a broader debate inside Big Oil about whether the energy transition is a threat to manage or an opportunity to capture.

4. The energy drinks market just got a lot more dramatic. Russ Savage — founder of Rockstar Energy — has been quietly building a stake in Celsius Holdings, a rival energy drink brand. What has he reportedly done next?

c. Savage built up a 4.7% stake in Celsius and is now seeking to install himself as chief executive — a genuinely unusual hostile move in which the founder of one brand tries to take over a direct competitor. Celsius has grown rapidly in recent years, challenging Monster and Red Bull, which makes it an attractive — if audacious — target.

Economics

5. Ghana's inflation (the rate at which prices across the economy are rising) has been falling, and July brought more good news. Inflation dropped to 4.6% in July, down from 5.3% in June. Which sector drove the latest monthly decline?

b. Falling food prices drove Ghana's inflation down to 4.6% in July. Food carries an outsized weight in consumer price indices (the official measure of inflation) in lower-income economies, because households spend a larger share of their income on eating than in wealthier countries. Ghana's inflation peaked above 50% in late 2022, so 4.6% represents a remarkable — if hard-won — stabilisation.

6. France has just announced a ban on unsolicited telemarketing calls — cold calls — starting next week, after years of complaints that existing rules weren't working. Which of the following is NOT a plausible economic risk of this kind of ban?

b. A telemarketing ban would not plausibly cause a spike in inflation (a general rise in prices across the economy). Job losses in call centres and lower revenues for direct-sales businesses are genuine risks — France has a significant outsourced call-centre industry. Inflation, though, is driven by factors like energy costs, supply chains, and monetary policy, not by how companies are allowed to find new customers.

7. Ahead of a planned visit by President Xi Jinping to Washington, China announced sweeping new trade curbs against the United States, including export controls on drones. What were these measures widely understood to be?

a. Beijing's export controls and bans on dealings with six American firms were a direct response to US restrictions on Chinese tech — part of the tit-for-tat trade and technology war that has escalated since 2018. Drones are a strategically sensitive sector; China dominates global drone manufacturing through companies like DJI, giving it real leverage in any technology standoff.

8. New OECD (the club of wealthy nations) data has revealed a striking disconnect between economic growth and ordinary living standards. In which two European countries did real household incomes — what families actually have to spend, adjusted for inflation — actually fall, even as the broader economy grew?

a. Real household incomes fell in both Greece and Austria despite overall economic growth — a sharp reminder that GDP (the total size of an economy) and living standards can move in opposite directions. In Greece, austerity-era scarring and weak wage growth are part of the story. In Austria, high inflation eroded purchasing power faster than incomes could catch up, leaving households worse off even in a technically growing economy.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cobalt, the metal essential for manufacturing the rechargeable batteries used in electric vehicles and smartphones?

a. The Democratic Republic of Congo produces roughly 70% of the world's cobalt — a staggering concentration of a single critical mineral in one country. This gives the DRC enormous strategic importance in the global electric vehicle supply chain, and has made cobalt mining a focal point of debate about labour conditions, Chinese investment in African resources, and Western supply chain security.

10. Which 18th-century economist, working as a customs officer in Scotland by day, wrote what many consider the founding text of modern capitalism in his spare time — a book published in 1776 that argued free markets and the division of labour drive national wealth?

a. Adam Smith published The Wealth of Nations in 1776 — the same year as American independence — while working as a Commissioner of Customs in Edinburgh. His concept of the 'invisible hand,' the idea that individuals pursuing self-interest can unintentionally benefit society, remains one of the most quoted and debated ideas in all of economics. Hume was his friend; Malthus came later and focused on population.